

Japan Semiconductors

Japan Semi Equipment: Potentially reversing share loss in China?



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Japanese equipment makers have been losing share in China, not only to Chinese domestic makers but to other overseas makers. Their market share among imports dropped from 26% in 2024 to 23% in 2025. Before that, their market share in China among imports peaked in 2021 at 30%. We believe that is one of the major concerns for investors, but the trend may reverse going onward.

The share loss can be explained: FX was a big reason for the nominal share loss. The JPY has depreciated 31.5% over the last 5 years, and Japanese WFE players tend to price their products in JPY. Adjusting for which the market share would have been 31%/26% (instead of 26%/23%) respectively in 2024/25, vs. 2023 adjusted market share of 27%, or 2021 share of 28%. **Investment timing was another major reason, causing Japan to lose share in 2025 after gaining share in 2024.** We believe some of the customers with historically higher Japanese presence such as CXMT not placing many orders in 2025 may have also caused some optical market share loss. Averaging out market share in 2024 and 25, the Japanese WFE companies' FX adjusted market share in China among imported equipment would be 28.6%, which is on par with average market share in 21-23 of 28.1%. This also suggests that 2025 share loss is mainly due to timing for order rather than structural loss. **There are also some specific reasons for each individual company.** All 3 front end equipment companies (TEL/Screen/Kokusai) lost share in 2025, but for different reasons. For Tokyo Electron, it was likely due to customer / process-step mix and timing, as well as historically less aggressive pricing. For Screen, it was likely due to order timing and customers' localization attempts, as cleaning is a segment where locals have become more credible, while for Kokusai it was likely mostly due to CXMT's investment timing.

We expect the Japanese equipment makers to reverse the share loss in China going forward. The FX should no longer be a headwind, and because of yen depreciation, the Japanese equipment is of considerably good value which allows them to raise prices. This, coupled with normalization of investment pattern among the Chinese customers, should allow the Japanese equipment makers to gain market share in China. Although Japan's market share among import hasn't necessarily been impressive YTD, we expect them to regain share in going forward as Chinese customers seem to have been ordering increasingly from Japan again, and we believe Japanese equipment makers have started to raise prices more actively. Specifically, **Tokyo Electron (OP)** has been more vocal on pricing, especially in China where certain tools remain difficult to be replaced by locals. Customer mix normalizing should also help. **Kokusai (OP)** could see China memory capacity expansion cycle to support demand, and we believe their core areas are not yet fully caught up by local competition. **Screen (MP)** expects orders from CXMT to come back after 2 years of no orders, as well as a sizeable order from JHICC.

We are positive on front end equipment companies — Tokyo Electron, Kokusai as well as Screen especially after the recent commodity / materials rally. SPEs have been underperforming the commodity semi names (memory, analog, substrate, wafer, etc.) in the past 2-3 months. We expect the strength for SPE companies to recover as investors recognize the capex increase in the next few years, as well as their potential share gain in China, and prefer TEL (OP) and Kokusai (OP).

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	11 Jun 2026		Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Reported EPS				Reported P/E (x)		
		Cur	Closing Price			Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
8035.JP (Tokyo Electron)	O	JPY	63,400	59,200	114.7%	JPY	1,250.88	1,504.14	1,848.77	50.7	42.2	34.3
7735.JP (Screen)	M	JPY	12,990	12,600	97.2%	JPY	486.61	572.60	662.24	26.7	22.7	19.6
6525.JP (Kokusai)	O	JPY	8,042.00	8,240.00	103.9%	JPY	128.63	200.23	274.61	62.5	40.2	29.3
002371.CH (NAURA)	O	CNY	637.50	680.00	71.1%	CNY	5.66	10.22	16.41	112.6	62.4	38.9
688012.CH (AMEC)	O	CNY	303.12	500.00	130.4%	CNY	3.40	4.95	7.18	89.2	61.3	42.2
688072.CH (Piotech)	O	CNY	655.27	580.00	322.3%	CNY	3.32	8.12	12.40	197.4	80.7	52.9
ASML (ASML)	O	USD	1,734.19	1,971.00	98.4%	USD	27.95	36.96	53.13	53.6	40.5	28.2
ASML.NA (ASML)	O	EUR	1,507.20	1,700.00	109.2%	EUR	24.72	32.69	46.98	61.0	46.1	32.1
JPL			2,508.65									
ASIAx			1,911.22									
SPX			7,394.30									
EDME			1,541.87									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We rate Tokyo Electron (TP=¥59,200) and Kokusai (TP=¥8,240.00 Outperform, and Screen (TP=¥12,600) Market-Perform.

We rate ASML (PT=€1,700.00) Outperform.

We rate Naura Outperform, with TP at CNY 680.

We rate AMEC Outperform, with TP at CNY 500.

We rate Piotech Outperform, with TP at CNY 580.

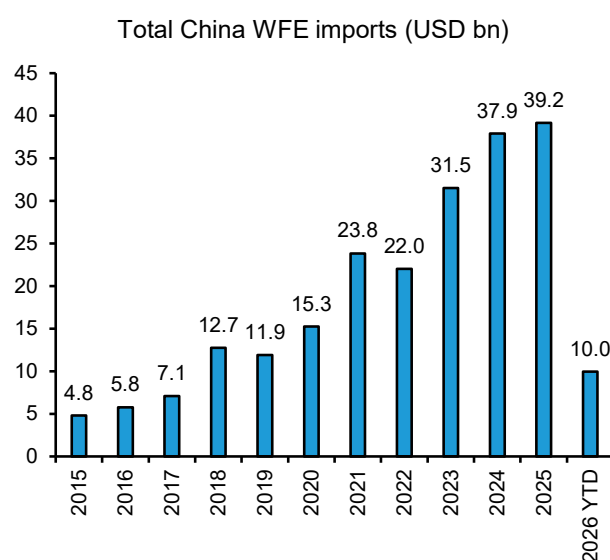
DETAILS

Japanese equipment makers, led by TEL, have been underperforming global peers in 2025 in growth and market share. One big reason for that is China, which represents c. 42% of global WFE as of 2025, where Japanese equipment makers have been losing share. In today's report, we examine the cause of the share loss, and discuss the future market share trend in China.

Japanese equipment makers have been losing share in China, not only to Chinese domestic makers but to other overseas makers. Their market share among imports dropped from 26% in 2024 to 23% in 2025. Before that, their market share in China among imports peaked in 2021 at 30%. However, we believe the trend may reverse going forward.

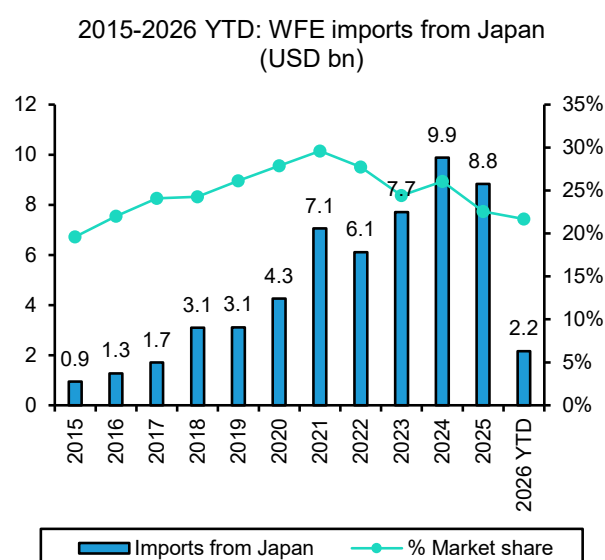
Japanese makers have been losing share in 2025 not only to domestic competition but among global players as well. Alongside China WFE market growth, WFE imports to China has been on a constant rise (Exhibit 1). Although, Japan's market share within WFE imports has been on a constant decline since 2021 peak. The absolute dollar amount of Japan-origin imports also fell in 2025 from the 2024 peak, and 2026 YTD (up to April) run-rate also appears lower than the 2025 level (Exhibit 2).

EXHIBIT 1: **WFE imports to China has been on a constant rise...**



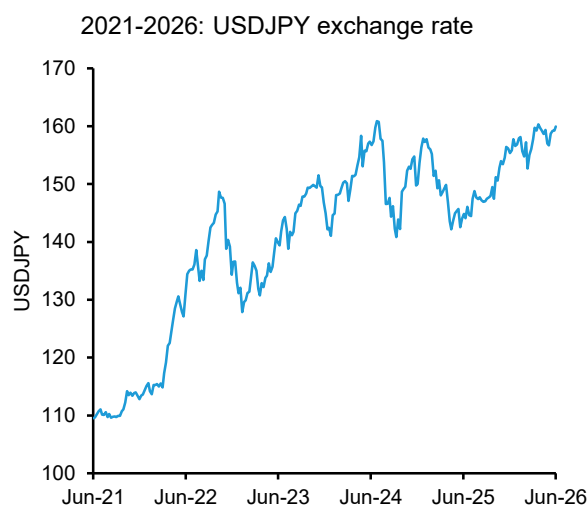
Source: General Administrations of Customs of PRC, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 2: **...but Japan has been constantly dropping market share since 2022.**

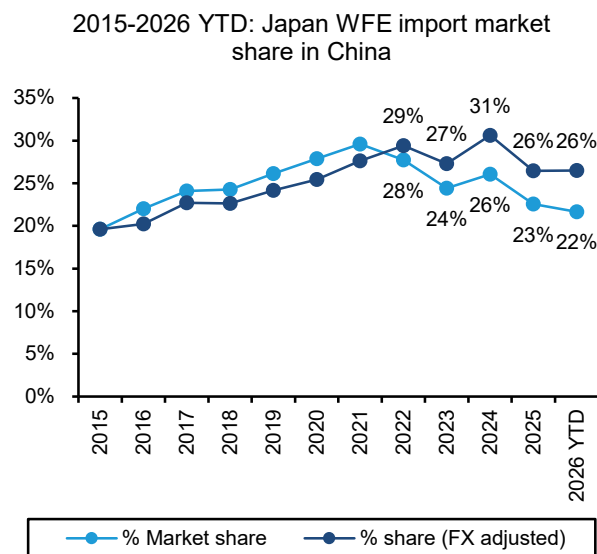


Source: General Administration of Customs of PRC, Bernstein analysis.

A big part of the reason for nominal share loss was FX. We would not attribute all of this to pure market share loss to competition. Firstly, the Japanese yen has depreciated 31.5% over the last 5 years (Exhibit 3), and we suspect that this FX movement definitely would have played a role since most of the Japanese WFE vendors price their equipment mostly in JPY. If we adjust for FX, Japan's market share loss can be seen as largely stable (Exhibit 4).

EXHIBIT 3: JPY has depreciated 31.5% over the last 5 years.

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 4: FX may have some impact on Japan's market share loss as they charge customers mostly in JPY.

USDJPY FX is indexed to 2015

Source: Bloomberg, General Administration of Customs of PRC, Bernstein analysis.

The other part is timing of order from different customers. For instance, CXMT as one of the Chinese companies who used a lot of Japanese equipments not only invested less overall last year due to fab expansion timing and their funding issues, but they also had tried to localize their equipment base and ordered less from Japan.

Averaging out market share in 2024 and 2025, the Japanese WFE companies' FX adjusted market share in China among imported equipment would be 28.6%, which is on par with average market share in 21-23 of 28.1%. This also suggests that 2025 share loss is mainly due to timing for order rather than structural loss.

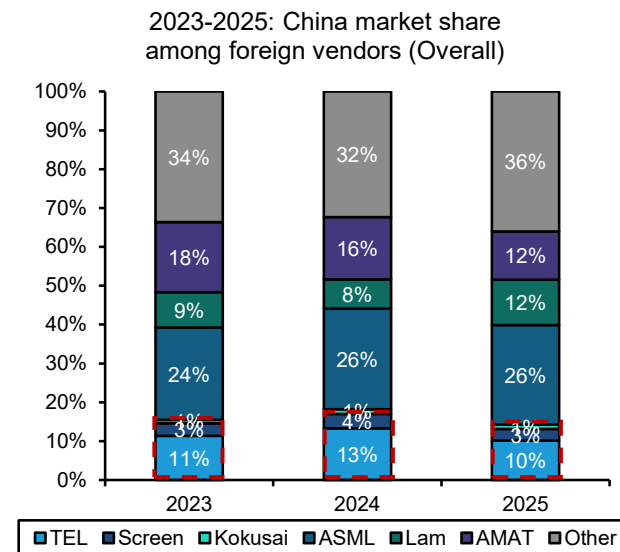
The company-level read-through is therefore more nuanced than the headline share decline. All three front-end equipment companies under our coverage appear to have lost share in 2025, but the reasons differ by company. We also believe part of the share loss could reverse in 2H26–2027, supported by customer order normalization and more active pricing by Japanese vendors.

There are also some specific reasons for each individual company. All 3 front end equipment companies (TEL/Screen/Kokusai) lost share in 2025, but for different reasons. Overall, it seems clear that Japanese WFE companies under our coverage lost some market share in 2025 (Exhibit 5, Exhibit 6), but we believe this share loss could be reversed going forward.

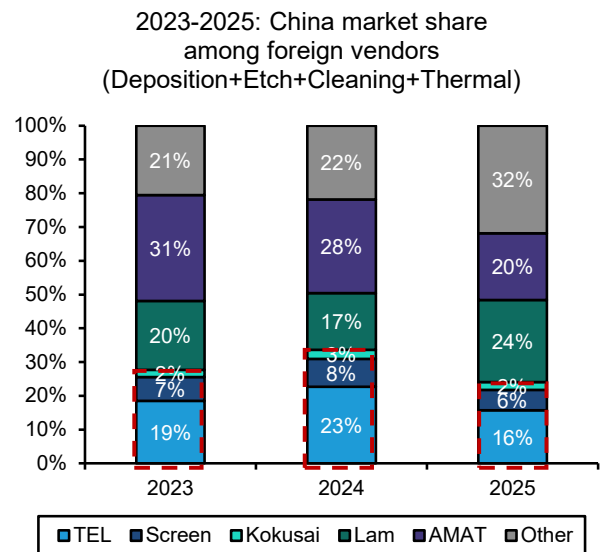
Tokyo Electron (OP): For TEL, we believe they wouldn't have necessarily lost POR market share even in 2025, and the nominal market share loss is attributable firstly to customer mix and their timing of investment. For instance, CXMT — for which TEL has a relatively high market share — didn't invest much last year. Secondly, TEL has historically priced less aggressively, which lost them quite a bit of market share given FX depreciation. Also, some product-level / process .step-level mix may have also impacted optical market share.

Screen (MP): For Screen, the 2025 share loss appears to have been driven by order timing and customer localization attempts. CXMT did not place meaningful orders with Screen over the last two years as it tried to localize parts of its equipment base, which likely hurt Screen's China share. Swaysure, a major customer of Screen's in China DRAM space, wasn't very successful and ceased investment in 2025, which also impacted Screen's market share.

Kokusai (OP): For Kokusai, the 2024-2025 market share loss we believe also had a lot to do with CXMT, as in 2024 we estimate CXMT accounted for around ¥47bn whereas in 2025 we believe CXMT investment faded to around ¥11bn.

EXHIBIT 5: Overall, Japanese vendors have lost some market share in 2025...

Source: Gartner, Company disclosures, Bernstein China Semi Team analysis and estimates.

EXHIBIT 6: ...and the trend looks more pronounced for the 4 segments with Japanese exposure.

Source: Gartner, Company disclosures, Bernstein China Semi Team analysis and estimates.

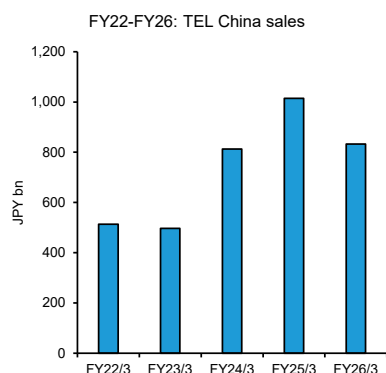
We expect them to regain share from 2H26 onward, especially with the active price raise. Going forward, the FX should no longer be a headwind, and because of yen depreciation of ~31% over the past 5 years, the Japanese equipment is of considerably good value which allows them to raise prices. This, coupled with normalization of investment pattern among the Chinese customers, should allow the Japanese equipment makers to gain market share in China (Exhibit 7-Exhibit 9).

TEL: We expect TEL's China share to improve from the weak 2025 level as customer mix normalizes and pricing becomes more supportive. TEL has recently been more vocal on pricing, especially in China, where it sees room for price increases given that certain tools remain difficult to replace with local alternatives. The company also appears to be introducing additional surcharges for cost increases and expedited delivery. Therefore, while 2025 share may have been weak, we do not think it should be extrapolated into 2026 and beyond.

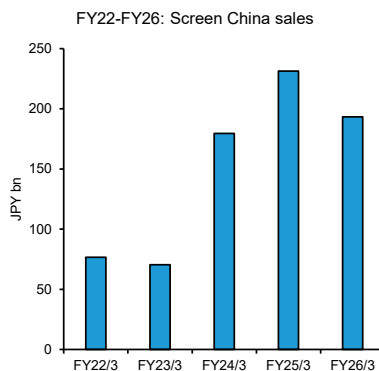
Screen: For Screen, we are now more constructive after our recent group call with the company. While they have also lost some nominal market share in 2025, Screen expects orders from CXMT to come back — who did not place orders for them in the last 2 years in an attempt to localize the equipments, a sizable order from JHICC, and YMTC ordering 1.5x of what they ordered last year. Foundry customers are expected to continue to rely heavily on Screen as well.

Kokusai: For Kokusai, we expect China memory capacity expansion to support demand, while local competition has not yet fully caught up in Kokusai's core areas. Therefore, although China thermal localization remains a medium-term risk, we do not think the 2025 China import-share data alone should change the investment thesis. Kokusai's near-term upside/downside should remain more driven by capacity constraints.

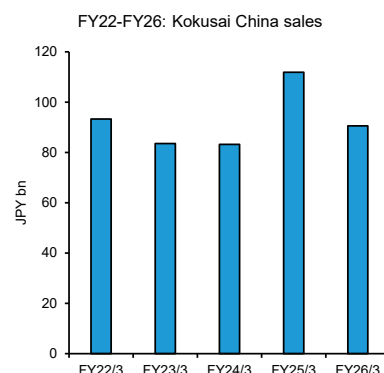
Meanwhile, SPEs have been underperforming the commodity semi names (memory, analog, substrate, wafer, etc.) in the past 2-3 months (Exhibit 10). We expect the strength for SPE companies to recover as investors recognize the capex increase in the next few years, as well as their potential share gain in China. Our pecking order in Japan frontend SPE is TEL (OP) > Kokusai (OP) > Screen (MP) for the China exposure.

EXHIBIT 7: TEL China's sales declined in FY26...

Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 8: ...as did Screen's...

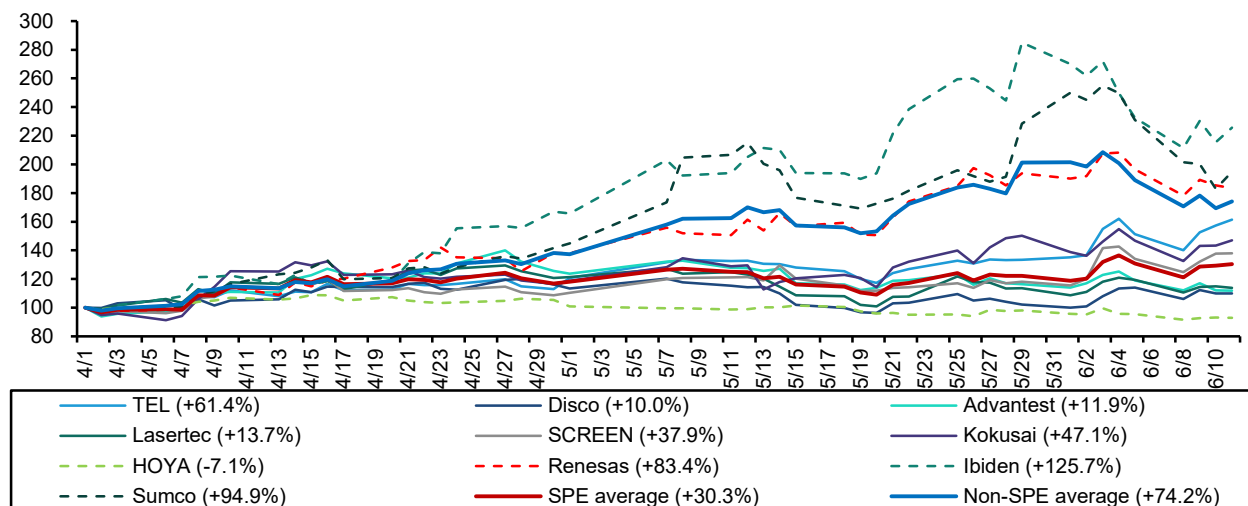
Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 9: ...and Kokusai's, but we expect them to resume growth.

Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 10: Over the last 2 months, SPEs have significantly underperformed analog (Renesas) and commodity (Ibiden / Sumco).

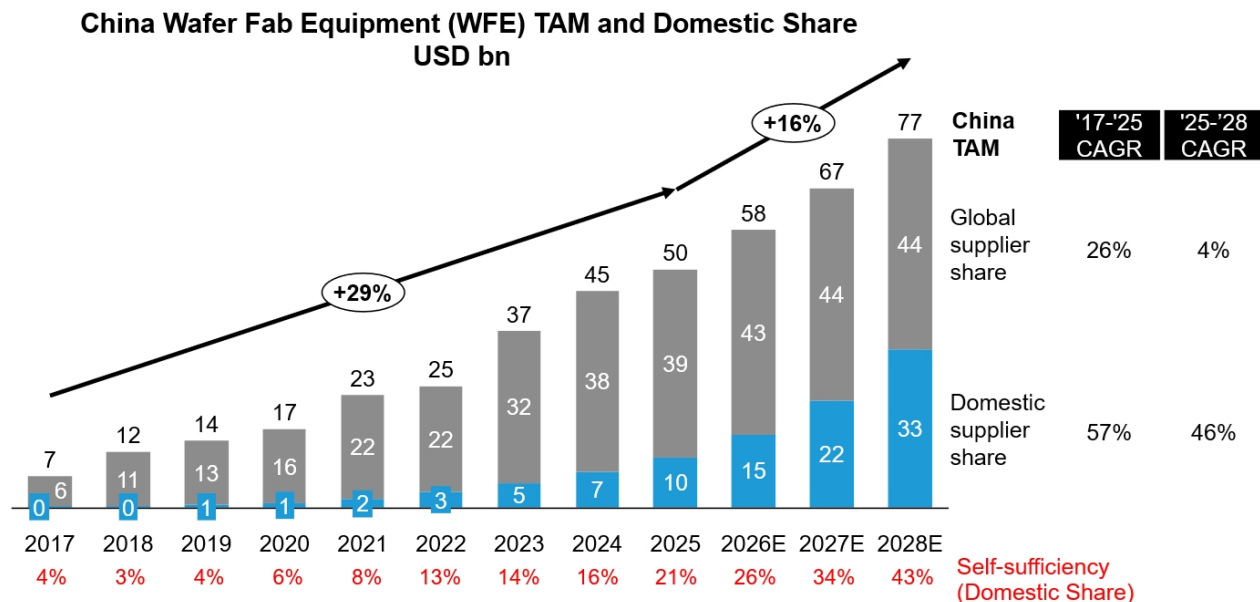
C2Q26 to date: Share price performance (indexed to 100)



Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis.

China WFE is still an important market for global equipment makers, despite continued localization. Overall, China remains a large and important WFE market (Exhibit 11) with \$50bn TAM composing c. 42% of global WFE as of 2025, supported by domestic fab expansion, localization of semiconductor manufacturing and ongoing investment by both logic/foundry and memory customers. Even as domestic WFE suppliers gain share, the absolute size of China WFE demand remains large enough to matter for global equipment vendors. This is particularly relevant for Japanese suppliers, as TEL, Screen and Kokusai all have meaningful China exposure.

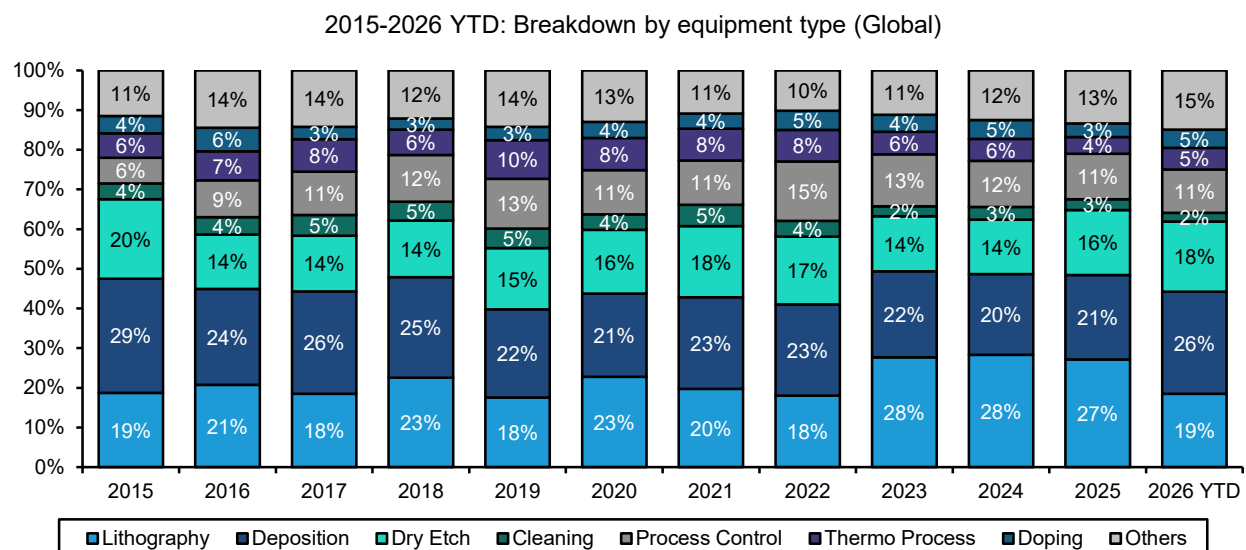
However, the key issue is no longer simply whether China WFE grows. The more important question is how much of that growth accrues to imported suppliers versus domestic vendors. China's self-sufficiency is expected to increase further, which means global vendors can face share pressure even if China WFE remains large.

EXHIBIT 11: **Chinese WFE market is growing, and self-sufficiency is expected to increase further.**

Source: Bernstein China Team estimates and analysis.

Detailed discussion / data for market share in China by product

Before discussing the detailed market share, one factor that impacts overall share is lithography intensity which has been significantly higher since 2023 onwards — from 18% in 2022 to 28% in 2023-2024 (Exhibit 12), and lithography is an area where Japan used to have some presence in the form of Canon (7751.JT, not covered) and Nikon (7731.JT, not covered) but is now mostly dominated by ASML (Outperform).

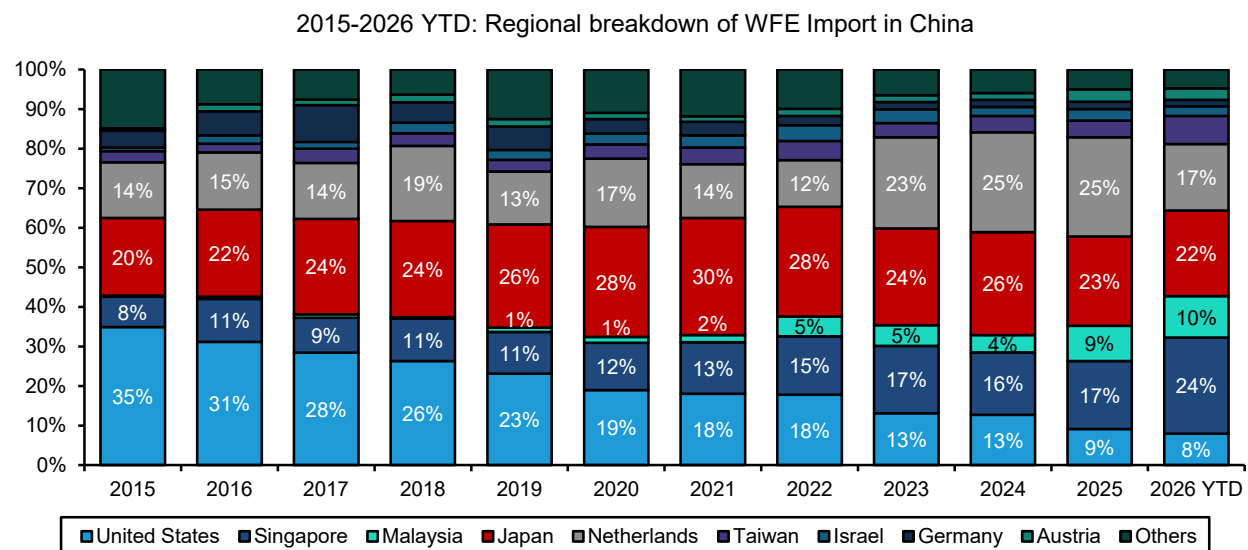
EXHIBIT 12: **Litho intensity was notably higher since 2023 onwards in China.**

Source: General Administration of Customs of PRC, Bernstein analysis.

On the other hand, more structurally, the import data suggests that Japan may actually be potentially losing market share to certain suppliers shipping from Malaysia — which likely represents Lam Research (LRCX.US, covered by Stacy Rasgon) — as well as Singapore — which likely represents Applied Materials (AMAT.US, covered by Stacy Rasgon) in the more recent years,

as we can see that Malaysia has increased its market share from 4% to 9% in 2025, and Singapore has increased market share from 17% to 24% in 2026 YTD while Japan lost 4% points of market (Exhibit 13). In the following sections, we examine product-level import data as well as our China team's proprietary company-level estimates to examine which products and/or companies may be causing this market share loss.

EXHIBIT 13: Conversely, Malaysia / Singapore have been gaining market share in recent years.



Source: General Administration of Customs of PRC, Bernstein analysis.

By product, dry etch and thermal process is seeing market share loss

At the product level, the most visible share loss is in dry etch as well as thermal process (Exhibit 15, Exhibit 16). Japan's share in China dry etch imports has declined sharply, and the market share loss from 2024 peak seems to be happening mostly to Lam Research who ships their etchers from Malaysia — which saw a significant uptick in 2025 to 39% from 24% in 2024 (Exhibit 17).

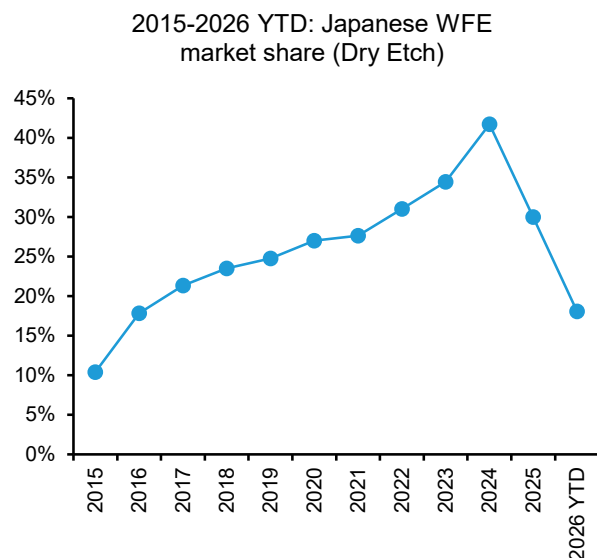
Although TEL may indeed be losing actual market share, we would assume TEL's share loss in dry etch could also be caused by both the lack of price hike on the side of TEL, as well as certain unfavourable process-step mix, as TEL is quite dominant in dielectric etch vs. Lam more in conductor etch (Exhibit 18, Exhibit 19).

EXHIBIT 14: Thermal processes, CMP, Dry etch, Cleaning, and Deposition are the segments in which China has achieved some degree of self-sufficiency.

Major Chinese Wafer Fab Equipment suppliers by segment (CY2025)											
Segment	Lithography	Deposition	Dry Etch	Process Control	Cleaning	CMP	Photoresist Processing	Doping	Thermal Processes	Other Mat. Removal	Mfg. Automation
Share of WFE	21%	25%	19%	10%	6%	3%	3%	2%	3%	1%	3%
China TAM (USD mn)	10,762	12,765	9,397	5,019	2,856	1,662	1,608	1,205	1,280	413	1,592
China supply (USD mn)	143	3,419	2,895	522	823	656	104	158	577	389	N/A
Self-sufficiency	1%	27%	31%	10%	29%	39%	6%	13%	45%	94%	N/A

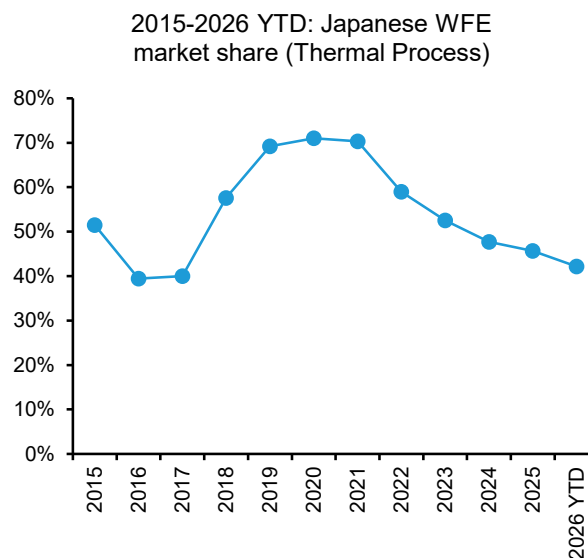
Source: Gartner, Company disclosures, Bernstein China Semi Team estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 15: **Japanese market share in Dry etch has dropped the most sharply.**



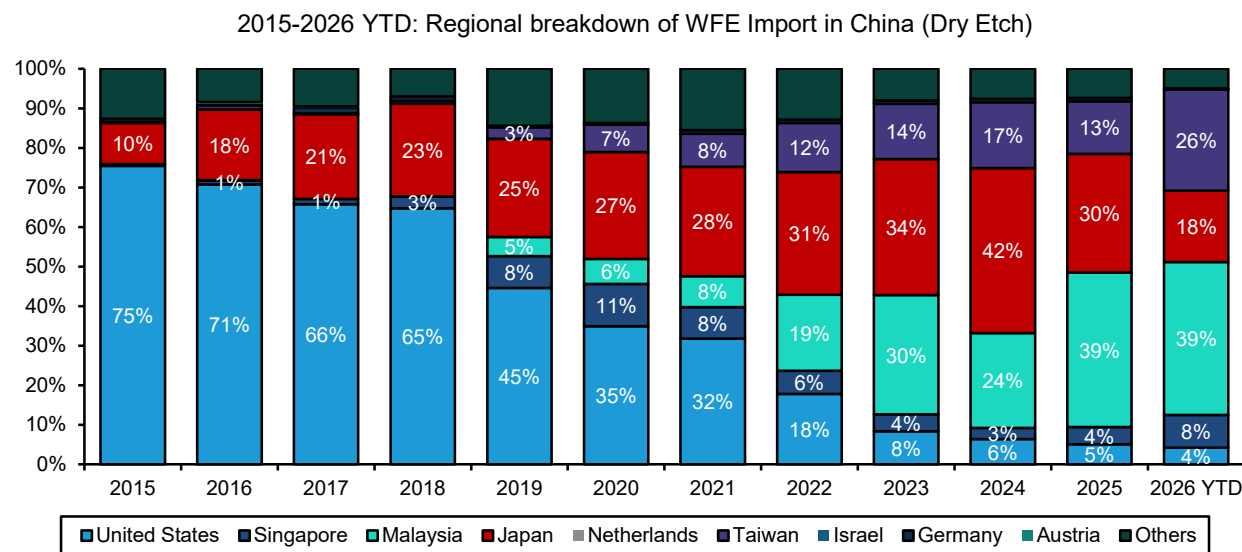
Market share among global players (excluding China local)
Source: General Administration of Customs of PRC, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 16: **Japanese Thermal process equipments has been consistently losing market share.**



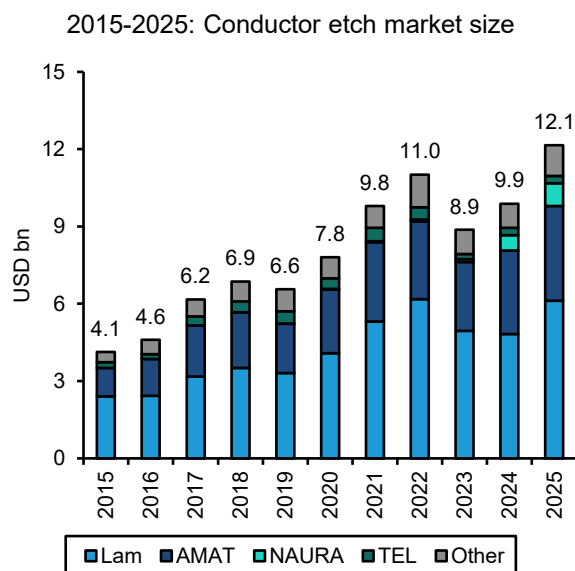
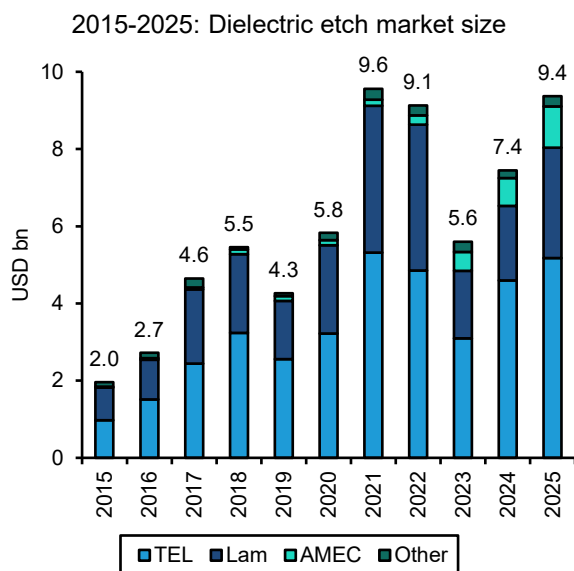
Market share among global players (excluding China local)
Source: General Administration of Customs of PRC, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 17: **Japan is losing market share in dry etch mainly to Malaysia, and 2026 YTD to Taiwan also.**



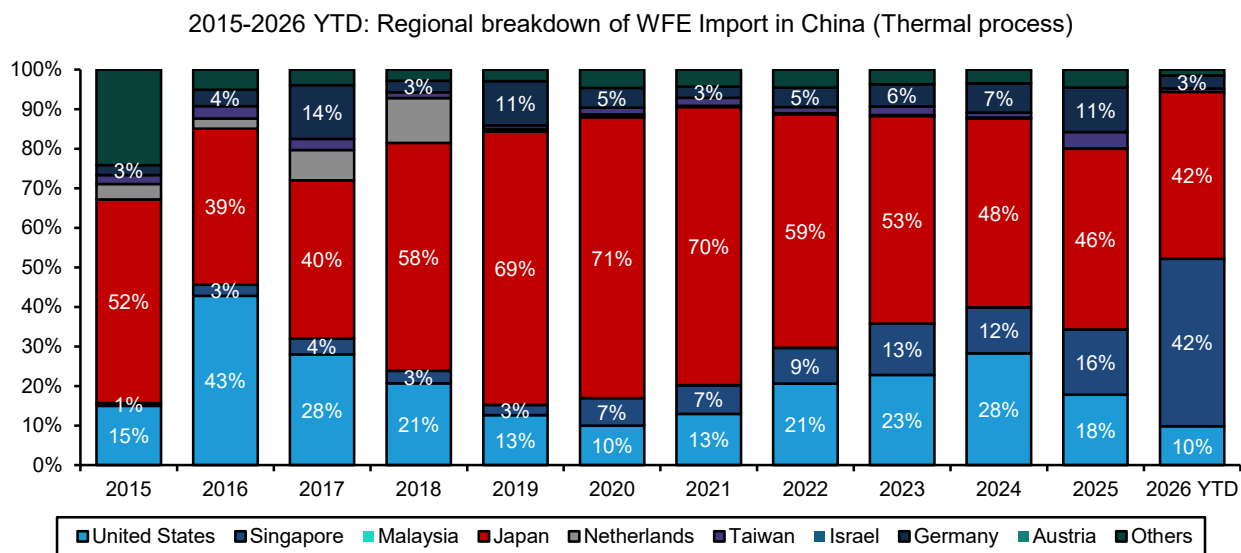
Market share among global players (excluding China local)
Source: General Administration of Customs of PRC, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 18: **TEL has a dominant market share in dielectric etch etch...** EXHIBIT 19: **...but has a minimal exposure to conductor etch etch.**



Source: TechInsights, Bernstein analysis.

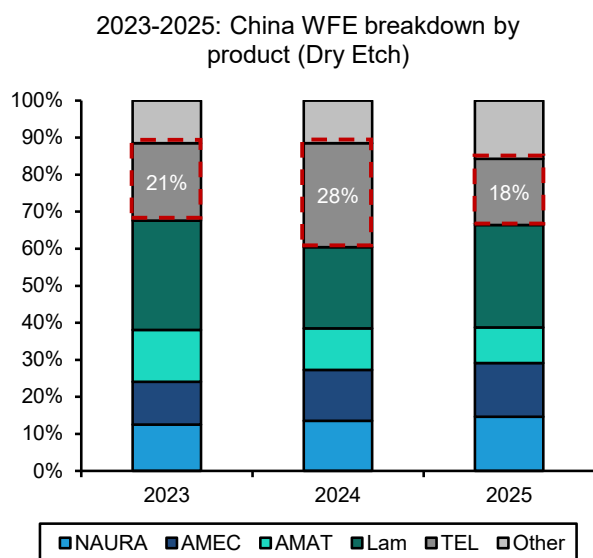
Source: TechInsights, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 20: **In thermal process, Japan is losing market share to both US and Singapore.**

Market share among global players (excluding China local)

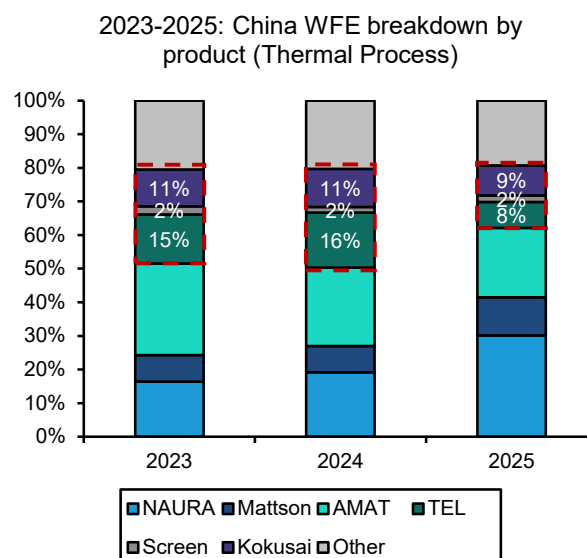
Source: General Administration of Customs of PRC, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 21: TEL's dry etch market share has declined significantly in 2025.



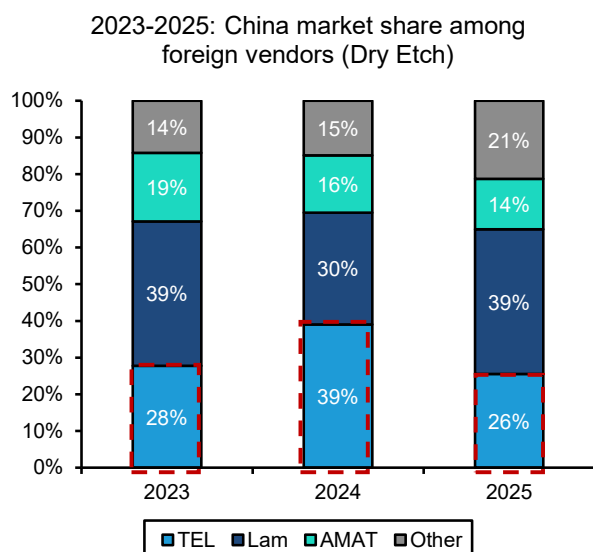
Source: Gartner, Company disclosures, Bernstein China Semi Team analysis and estimates.

EXHIBIT 22: Japanese companies seem to have dropped significant market share for thermal process.



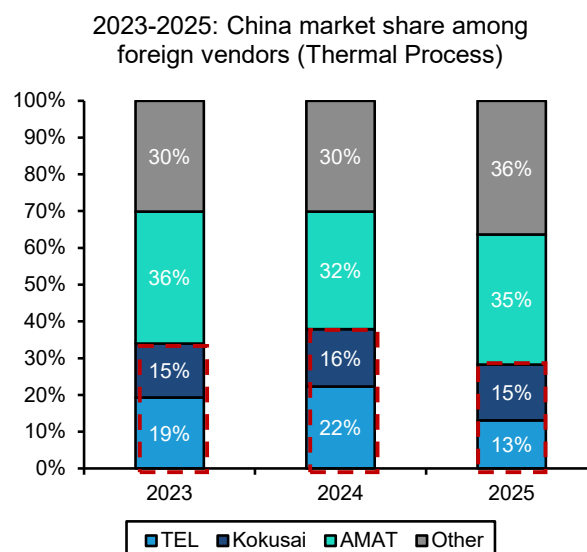
Source: Gartner, Company disclosures, Bernstein China Semi Team analysis and estimates.

EXHIBIT 23: Among foreign vendors, LRCX has gained market share within etch.



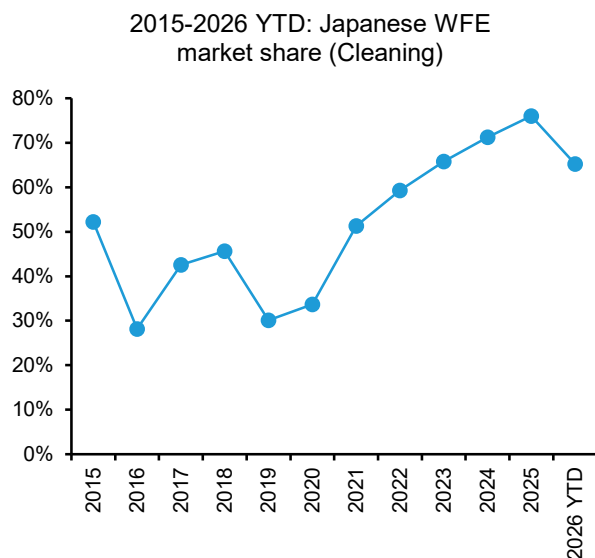
Source: Gartner, Company disclosures, Bernstein China Semi Team analysis and estimates.

EXHIBIT 24: Among foreign vendors, AMAT has gained market share within thermal processes.

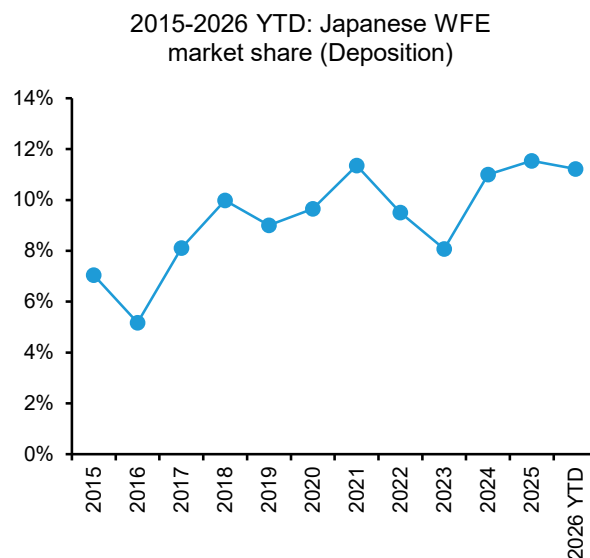


Source: Gartner, Company disclosures, Bernstein China Semi Team analysis and estimates.

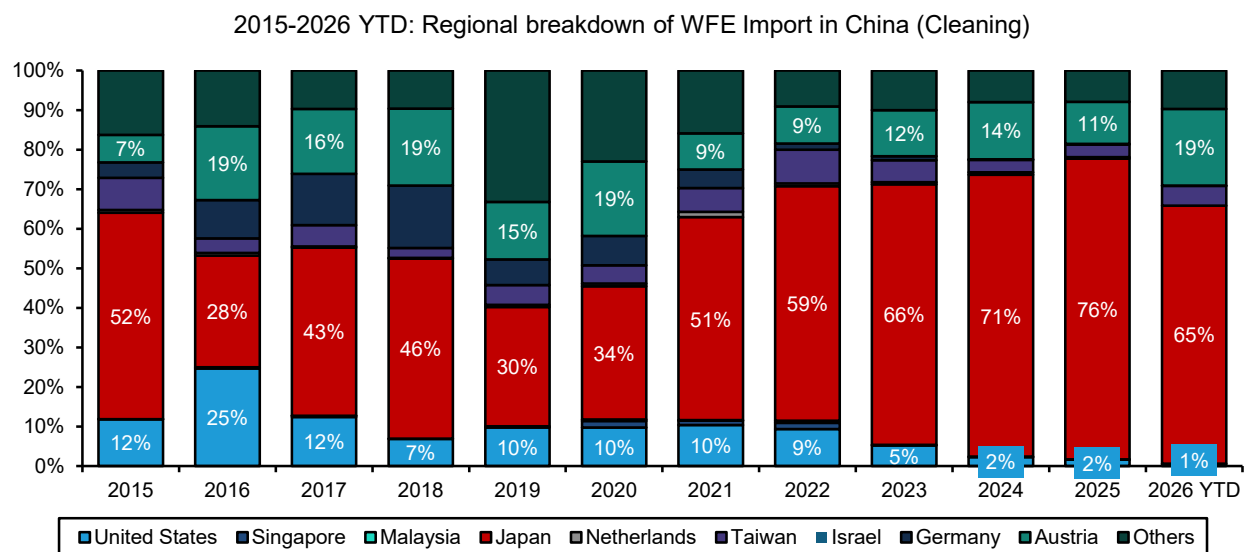
For cleaning and deposition, Japanese makers have been performing relatively better (Exhibit 25, Exhibit 26) than other segments. Japan's market share within cleaning equipment import rose to 76% in 2025 from 30% in 2019 trough, and deposition has maintained market share over the last two years.

EXHIBIT 25: Japanese cleaning equipment has gained market share over the years.

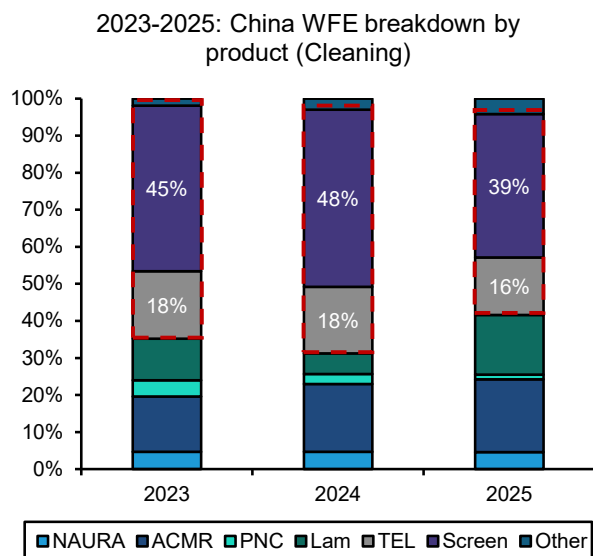
Market share among global players (excluding China local)
Source: General Administration of Customs of PRC, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 26: Deposition market share has been rather stable over the years.

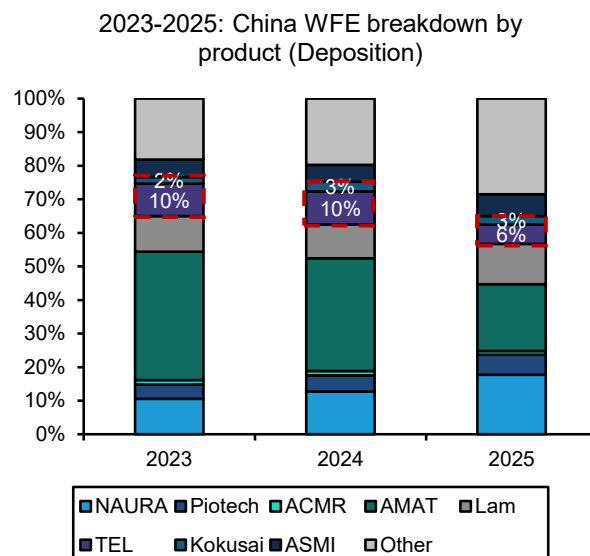
Market share among global players (excluding China local)
Source: General Administration of Customs of PRC, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 27: Japan is losing some market share in 2026 YTD to Austria.

Market share among global players (excluding China local)
Source: General Administration of Customs of PRC, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 28: **For cleaning, Screen / TEL's 2025 market share declined significantly.**

Source: Gartner, Company disclosures, Bernstein China Semi Team analysis and estimates.

EXHIBIT 29: **Japan WFE vendors' deposition market share declined in 2025.**

Source: Gartner, Company disclosures, Bernstein China Semi Team analysis and estimates.

DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

I. REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

References to "Bernstein" or the "Firm" in these disclosures relate to the following entities: Bernstein Institutional Services LLC (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein & Co., LLC (pre April 1, 2024), Bernstein Autonomous LLP, BSG France S.A. (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司, Sanford C. Bernstein (Canada) Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited (SEBI registration no. INH000006378), Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK (サンフォード・C・バーンスタイン株式会社) and analysts employed by Société Générale Africa Technologies & Services to produce Bernstein research under a Global Services Agreement in place between Bernstein and Société Générale.

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